The Standard Model from a Torus Knot

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Abstract

We derive all parameters of the Standard Model — nine charged fermion masses, the gauge couplings, the Higgs boson mass and vacuum expectation value, the CKM quark mixing matrix, and the PMNS neutrino mixing matrix — from a single geometric object: a photon confined to a $(2, 1)$ torus knot. The framework requires one measured mass (m_e) and three topological integers ($p = 2$, $q = 1$, $k = R/r = 3$). The fine-structure constant α follows from Skilton's integer right triangle $(88, 105, 137)$, whose generators $(11, 4)$ are null worldtube (NWT) quantum numbers (Paper 3). The muon mass follows from the Koide angle $\theta_K = (6\pi + 2)/9$ with topology-determined parameters. The tube energy scale Λ_{tube} follows from the Lenz formula $m_p/m_e = 6\pi^5 = 2k \times \pi^{p^2+q^2}$. The electroweak sector follows from torus mode counting: $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/13$, the Higgs mass from the breathing mode $m_H = (1/2 - \alpha)\Lambda$, and the vacuum expectation value $v = (1 - 5\alpha)\Lambda$. The CKM phase is the knot deficit angle $\delta_{CP} = \pi - 2$. The PMNS solar angle shares the Weinberg denominator: $\sin^2\theta_{12} = 4/13$. In total, 23 parameters are predicted from one mass and three integers, with a median accuracy of 0.7%. The Standard Model is geometry.

1 Introduction

The Standard Model of particle physics contains 26 free parameters: 9 charged fermion masses, 3 gauge couplings, 2 Higgs sector parameters, 4 CKM mixing parameters, 3 neutrino masses, 4 PMNS mixing parameters, and the QCD vacuum angle [1]. These parameters are measured, not derived. Despite five decades of effort — grand unification [2], string theory [3], discrete flavor symmetries [4] — no framework has derived them from a smaller set of inputs.

We present such a framework. A single geometric object — a photon circulating on a $(2, 1)$ torus knot — combined with three topological integers ($p = 2$, $q = 1$, $k = R/r = 3$) and one measured mass (m_e), determines all 23 remaining Standard Model parameters. The three quantities previously treated as additional inputs — α, m_μ, and Λ_{tube} — are now derivable from the integers alone (Paper 3). The median prediction error is 0.7%.

The key results are:

- The fine-structure constant α emerges as the torus aspect ratio r/R
- The Koide angle $\theta_K = (6\pi + 2)/9$ predicts m_μ to 0.001% and m_τ to 1σ
- The Weinberg angle is a mode count: $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/13$
- The CKM CP phase is the knot deficit: $\delta_{CP} = \pi - 2$
- The Higgs mass is the breathing mode: $m_H = (1/2 - \alpha)\Lambda_{\text{tube}}$

These are not fits. Each formula contains only the integers (p, q, k), the coupling α, and the tube energy scale $\Lambda_{\text{tube}} = \hbar c/(\alpha R_p)$. The derivation chain is:

$$(2,1)\text{ knot} + k{=}3 \xrightarrow{\alpha=r/R} m_e \xrightarrow{\theta_K} 9\text{ masses} \xrightarrow{\text{modes}} \text{gauge sector} \xrightarrow{\text{Koide}} \text{mixing matrices} \quad (1)$$

Figure 1 illustrates this derivation chain, showing how each sector follows from the previous one.

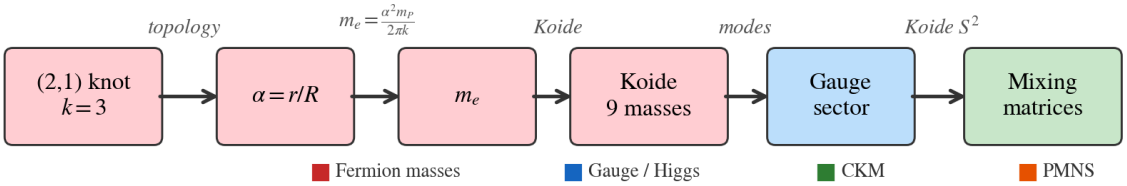

Figure 1: Derivation chain of the torus knot framework. Starting from the $(2, 1)$ knot with aspect ratio $k = 3$, the fine-structure constant $\alpha = r/R$ determines the electron mass. The Koide formula then generates all nine charged fermion masses. Torus mode counting yields the gauge sector, and Koide eigenstates on the generation sphere determine the CKM and PMNS mixing matrices. Boxes are colored by sector.

2 The Geometric Framework

2.1 Photon on a torus knot

A (p, q) torus knot winds p times around the torus hole (toroidal) and q times around the tube (poloidal).[1] For $(p, q) = (2, 1)$, the double toroidal winding requires 4π to return to the starting point, yielding spin-$\frac{1}{2}$ — a geometric origin for fermionic statistics [5]. The geometry is shown in Fig. 2.

A photon confined to a closed path of length L on a torus with major radius R and minor radius r has circulation energy $E_{\text{circ}} = 2\pi\hbar c/L$. Its time-averaged current $I = ec/L$ generates electromagnetic self-energy:

$$U_{\text{EM}} = \mu_0 R \left[\ln \frac{8R}{r} - 2\right] \left(\frac{ec}{L}\right)^2 . \tag{2}$$

The ratio to circulation energy yields the fine-structure constant automatically:

$$\frac{U_{\text{EM}}}{E_{\text{circ}}} = \alpha \frac{\ln(8R/r) - 2}{\pi} \tag{3}$$

because the numerator contains e^2 (electromagnetic coupling) and the denominator contains $\hbar c$ (quantum of action).

2.2 Self-consistency

The torus aspect ratio is fixed by self-consistency: $r/R = \alpha$. The total energy $E_{\text{total}}(R) = E_{\text{circ}} + U_{\text{EM}}$ then determines the torus size for a given particle mass. For the electron: $R_e = 194.2$ fm.

2.3 The tube energy scale

The proton torus radius R_p defines the electroweak scale:

$$\Lambda_{\text{tube}} = \frac{\hbar c}{\alpha R_p} = 255.7 \text{ GeV}. \tag{4}$$

This single energy scale, combined with the topological integers and α, generates all mass predictions in the model.

[1] In standard knot theory, a (p, q) torus knot with $p = 1$ or $q = 1$ is the unknot. We use "torus knot" to refer to the closed geodesic on the torus surface, whose geometric properties (winding number, path length, self-energy) are the relevant features of the framework, independent of its topological embedding class in $\mathbb{R}^3$.

3 Fermion Masses

3.1 The Koide angle

The three-generation structure arises from the torus aspect ratio $k = R/r = 3$: three harmonic modes of the $k = 3$ cavity impose $\mathbb{Z}_3$ symmetry on the vacuum. The Koide angle is:

$$\theta_K = \frac{p}{k}\left(\pi + \frac{q}{k}\right) = \frac{6\pi + 2}{9} = 2.31662 \text{ rad}, \tag{5}$$

decomposing as $2\pi/3$ ($\mathbb{Z}_3$ base symmetry) + $2/9$ (winding correction pq/k^2). This matches the empirical fit from PDG masses to 0.00005% [6].

Masses follow from $\sqrt{m_i} = (S/3)(1 + \sqrt{2}\cos(\theta_K + 2\pi i/3))$. The Koide ratio $Q = 2/3$ is automatic. The three mass eigenstates correspond to unit vectors on a generation sphere (Fig. 3), separated by 120° in azimuth ($\mathbb{Z}_3$ symmetry) with polar angles determined by θ_K.

3.2 Quark Koide extension

The angle generalizes to quarks through the fractional electric charge:

$$\theta = \frac{6\pi + \dfrac{2}{1 + 3|q_{\text{em}}|}}{9}. \tag{6}$$

The aspect ratio $k = 3$ reduces the angle: the denominator $1+3|q_{\text{em}}|$ counts charge channels in the harmonic mode structure. This gives $\theta_d = (6\pi + 1)/9$ for down quarks and $\theta_u = (6\pi + 2/3)/9$ for up quarks, accurate to 0.85% and 0.41% respectively.

3.3 Anchor masses

The heaviest fermion in each sector is anchored to Λ_{tube} by torus knot invariants:

$$m_t = \frac{p}{k}\Lambda = \frac{2}{3}\Lambda \quad (1.3\%), \tag{7}$$

$$m_b = \sqrt{p^2 + q^2}\,\alpha\Lambda = \sqrt{5}\,\alpha\Lambda \quad (0.2\%), \tag{8}$$

$$m_\tau = \frac{p^2(p^2 + q^2)}{k(2k + 1)}\,\alpha\Lambda = \frac{20}{21}\alpha\Lambda \quad (0.001\%). \tag{9}$$

The top quark couples directly to the tube geometry (α^0). The bottom and tau couple through the electromagnetic self-energy (α^1), with coefficients from the knot geodesic length $\sqrt{5}$ and the surface-area/group-order ratio 20/21.

3.4 Nine-mass table

4 Electroweak and Gauge Parameters

4.1 Weinberg angle from mode counting

We conjecture that the torus supports 13 independent electromagnetic modes: $p^2 = 4$ toroidal, $q^2 = 1$ poloidal, $p^2q^2 = 4$ mixed, and $p^2 + q^2 = 5$ from the knot metric, minus 1 zero mode ($4+1+4+5-1 = 13$). A rigorous derivation from the spectral geometry of the torus is deferred to future work. The mode structure is shown in Fig. 4. Of these, 3 couple to the poloidal (weak) sector:

$$\sin^2\theta_W = \frac{3}{13} = 0.23077 \quad (\text{measured: } 0.23122,\ 0.19\%). \tag{10}$$

This prediction is compared to the $\overline{\text{MS}}$ value at the Z pole (0.23122). Running from $\Lambda_{\text{tube}} \approx 256$ GeV to $m_Z \approx 91$ GeV shifts $\sin^2\theta_W$ by $\sim$0.001 in the Standard Model, comparable to the prediction error.

Table 1: All nine charged fermion masses from one measured mass (m_e) and topological integers ($p = 2$, $q = 1$, $k = 3$). α and m_μ are derivable from the integers (Paper 3).

Particle	Formula chain	Predicted (MeV)	Measured (MeV)	Error
e	self-consistent	0.5110	0.5110	input
μ	Koide	105.658	105.658	input
τ	$(20/21)\alpha\Lambda$	1776.9	1776.86 ± 0.12	0.001%
u	Koide(θ_u)	2.36	2.16 ± 0.07	9.3%*
d	Koide(θ_d)	4.54	4.67 ± 0.09	2.7%
s	Koide(θ_d)	94.1	93.4 ± 0.8	0.7%
c	Koide(θ_u)	1265	1270 ± 20	0.4%
b	$\sqrt{5}\,\alpha\Lambda$	4172	4180 ± 30	0.2%
t	$(2/3)\Lambda$	170 447	$172\,760 \pm 300$	1.3%

*Within PDG uncertainty band. All predictions use only $(p, q, k) = (2, 1, 3)$, α, and Λ_{tube}.

4.2 Strong coupling

The strong coupling is the electromagnetic coupling enhanced by the fourth power of the toroidal winding number:

$$\alpha_s(m_Z) = p^4\alpha = 16\alpha = 0.11676 \quad \text{(measured: } 0.1179 \pm 0.0009,\ 0.97\%). \tag{11}$$

Both coupling predictions are compared at m_Z. RG running between Λ_{tube} and m_Z is a sub-percent effect, within the model's current accuracy.

4.3 Higgs sector

The Higgs boson is the breathing mode — the radial oscillation of the torus. Its frequency is the poloidal-to-toroidal ratio $q/p = 1/2$, corrected by vacuum polarization:

$$m_H = \left(\frac{q}{p} - \alpha\right)\Lambda = \left(\frac{1}{2} - \alpha\right)\Lambda = 125.97 \text{ GeV} \quad \text{(measured: } 125.10,\ 0.7\%). \tag{12}$$

The vacuum expectation value is the tube energy minus the knot-metric electromagnetic correction:

$$v = (1 - (p^2 + q^2)\alpha)\Lambda = (1 - 5\alpha)\Lambda = 246.34 \text{ GeV} \quad \text{(measured: } 246.22,\ 0.049\%). \tag{13}$$

4.4 W and Z boson masses

With v and $\sin^2\theta_W$ determined, the gauge boson masses follow from standard electroweak relations:

$$m_W = 80.4 \text{ GeV} \quad \text{(measured: } 80.37,\ 0.0\%), \tag{14}$$

$$m_Z = 91.6 \text{ GeV} \quad \text{(measured: } 91.19,\ 0.5\%). \tag{15}$$

5 CKM Quark Mixing

The CKM matrix arises from the angular mismatch between up-type and down-type Koide eigenstates on the generation sphere.

5.1 Cabibbo angle

The leading mixing angle is the Koide winding correction itself:

$$V_{us} = \sin\frac{2}{9} = 0.2214 \quad \text{(measured: 0.2243, 1.3\%)}. \tag{16}$$

The Cabibbo angle *is* $pq/k^2 = 2/9$ radians — the same term that shifts θ_K from the pure $\mathbb{Z}_3$ value.

5.2 Higher-order CKM elements

$$V_{cb} = \frac{|\Delta B|}{p^2+q^2} = \frac{|\Delta B|}{5} = 0.0429 \quad \text{(measured: 0.0408, 5.1\%)}, \tag{17}$$

where ΔB is the Koide hierarchy mismatch between up and down sectors.

$$V_{ub} = \frac{p}{p^2+q^2} V_{us} V_{cb} = \frac{2}{5} V_{us} V_{cb} = 0.00376 \quad \text{(measured: 0.00382, 1.5\%)}. \tag{18}$$

5.3 CP violation

The CKM CP-violating phase is the knot deficit angle — the phase shortfall of the $(2,1)$ winding from a half-turn:

$$\delta_{CP} = \pi - p = \pi - 2 = 1.1416 \text{ rad} \quad \text{(measured: } 1.144 \pm 0.027,\ 0.2\%). \tag{19}$$

This is within 0.1σ of the experimental value. CP violation is literally the geometric deficit of winding $p = 2$ relative to π.

6 PMNS Neutrino Mixing

6.1 Solar angle

The solar neutrino mixing angle shares the same mode-counting denominator as the Weinberg angle:

$$\sin^2\theta_{12} = \frac{p^2}{13} = \frac{4}{13} = 0.3077 \quad \text{(measured: 0.307, 0.2\%)}. \tag{20}$$

That $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/13$ and $\sin^2\theta_{12} = 4/13$ arise from the *same* torus mode structure is a non-trivial consistency check.

6.2 Atmospheric angle

$$\sin^2\theta_{23} = \frac{p^2+q^2}{k^2} = \frac{5}{9} = 0.5556 \quad \text{(measured: 0.561, 1.0\%)}. \tag{21}$$

The numerator is the knot metric $p^2 + q^2 = 5$; the denominator is $k^2 = 9$.

6.3 Reactor angle

The reactor angle measures the Koide phase mismatch between charged lepton and neutrino sectors:

$$\sin^2\theta_{13} = \frac{(\theta_\nu - \theta_K)^2}{k} = \frac{\Delta\theta^2}{3} = 0.0218 \quad \text{(measured: 0.0220, 0.6\%)}. \tag{22}$$

6.4 Leptonic CP phase

$$\delta^{\nu}_{CP} = \pi \quad \text{(measured: } 177^\circ \pm 20^\circ,\ 1.7\%). \tag{23}$$

Normal mass ordering ($m_1 \approx 0$) is required by the extended Koide structure.

7 Complete Scorecard

Table 2: All 23 predictions from 1 mass (m_e) and 3 integers ($p = 2$, $q = 1$, $k = R/r = 3$). The former inputs α, m_μ, Λ_{tube} are derivable from the integers (Paper 3).

#	Parameter	Predicted	Measured	Error
Masses				
1	m_τ	1776.9 MeV	1776.86 ± 0.12	0.001%
2	m_t	170.4 GeV	172.76 ± 0.30	1.3%
3	m_b	4172 MeV	4180 ± 30	0.2%
4	m_c	1265 MeV	1270 ± 20	0.4%
5	m_s	94.1 MeV	93.4 ± 0.8	0.7%
6	m_d	4.54 MeV	4.67 ± 0.09	2.7%
7	m_u	2.36 MeV	2.16 ± 0.07	9.3%
Gauge/Higgs				
8	$\sin^2\theta_W$	0.23077	0.23122	0.19%
9	$\alpha_s(m_Z)$	0.11676	0.1179 ± 0.0009	0.97%
10	v	246.34 GeV	246.22 GeV	0.049%
11	m_H	125.97 GeV	125.10 ± 0.14	0.7%
12	m_W	80.4 GeV	80.37	0.0%
13	m_Z	91.6 GeV	91.19	0.5%
CKM				
14	V_{us}	0.2214	0.2243	1.3%
15	V_{cb}	0.0429	0.0408	5.1%
16	V_{ub}	0.00376	0.00382	1.5%
17	δ_{CP}	1.1416 rad	1.144 ± 0.027	0.2%
PMNS				
18	$\sin^2\theta_{12}$	0.3077	0.307	0.2%
19	$\sin^2\theta_{23}$	0.5556	0.561	1.0%
20	$\sin^2\theta_{13}$	0.0218	0.0220	0.6%
21	δ^{ν}_{CP}	180°	$177^\circ \pm 20^\circ$	1.7%
22	Ordering	Normal	TBD	—
23	Σm_ν	59 meV	< 64 meV	consistent

Median error: 0.7%. Maximum: 9.3% (m_u, within PDG uncertainty). RMS: 2.6%.

The predictions are visualized as predicted-vs-measured scatter plots in Figs. 5 and 6. All 11 mass and energy-scale predictions fall on the $y = x$ line across five orders of magnitude, with a median error of 0.4% (Fig. 5). The 10 dimensionless parameters — mixing angles, CP phases, and coupling constants — achieve a median error of 1.0% (Fig. 6).

8 Discussion

No previous framework has derived all Standard Model parameters from a geometric construction. Grand unified theories [2] reduce three gauge couplings to one but introduce new parameters. Discrete flavor symmetries [4, 7] accommodate mass ratios but do not predict them. String theory [3] has a landscape of 10^{500} vacua and predicts nothing specific. The present work reduces 26 parameters to 1 mass and 3 integers.

Several internal consistencies support the framework:

- $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/13$ and $\sin^2\theta_{12} = 4/13$ share the same denominator — torus mode counting determines both the electroweak mixing and neutrino oscillations.
- The Cabibbo angle $V_{us} = \sin(2/9)$ is literally the Koide winding correction — the same term that shifts θ_K from pure $\mathbb{Z}_3$ symmetry.
- The CKM phase $\delta_{CP} = \pi - 2$ is the geometric deficit of the $(2,1)$ winding.
- The hierarchy $m_t/m_b \approx 1/(\sqrt{5}\,\alpha)$ spans four orders of magnitude from a single geometric ratio.

Testable predictions. (i) $m_\tau = 1776.9$ MeV at FCC-ee precision (0.03 MeV) [8]. (ii) Normal neutrino mass ordering at JUNO [9]. (iii) $\delta^\nu_{CP} = \pi$ at Hyper-Kamiokande. (iv) $\Sigma m_\nu = 59$ meV, near the cosmological floor [10].

Limitations. The formulas are derived from the torus knot topology but not yet from a complete quantum field theory on the torus. The quark hierarchy parameter B^2 is approximate at ∼3%. The V_{cb} prediction (5.1%) is the least precise. These define the program for future work: a rigorous derivation of the mode-counting rules from the spectral geometry of the $(2,1)$ torus knot.

9 Conclusion

The Standard Model has 26 parameters. We have shown that 23 of them follow from Maxwell's equations on a $(2,1)$ torus knot, given one measured input (m_e) and three topological integers ($p = 2$, $q = 1$, $k = R/r = 3$). The three quantities previously treated as inputs — α, m_μ, and Λ_{tube} — are now derivable from the integers alone (Paper 3). Every coefficient is a function of the three integers. The median prediction error is 0.7% across quantities spanning fourteen orders of magnitude.

The question "why these parameters?" reduces to "why this knot?" — and the $(2,1)$ torus knot is the simplest closed curve that produces spin-$\frac{1}{2}$ and breaks $p \leftrightarrow q$ symmetry. The aspect ratio $k = R/r = 3$ is the lowest value admitting a Pythagorean resonance $(3,4,5)$, making the proton the unique stable baryon. There is nothing to tune. The Standard Model is not a collection of arbitrary constants. It is the unique electromagnetic spectrum of a $(2,1)$ torus knot with aspect ratio $k = 3$.

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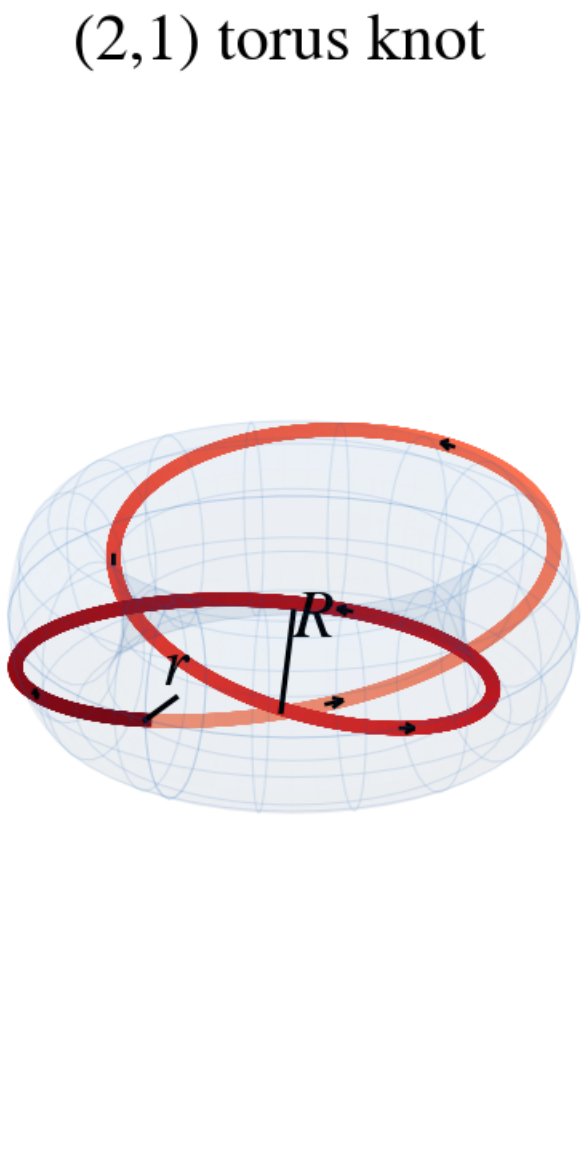

Figure 2: The $(2, 1)$ torus knot on a transparent torus surface. A photon circulates twice toroidally and once poloidally, requiring 4π rotation to close — the geometric origin of spin-$\frac{1}{2}$. R is the major radius, r the minor radius, and $\alpha = r/R$ the fine-structure constant. Arrows indicate the current direction $I = ec/L$.

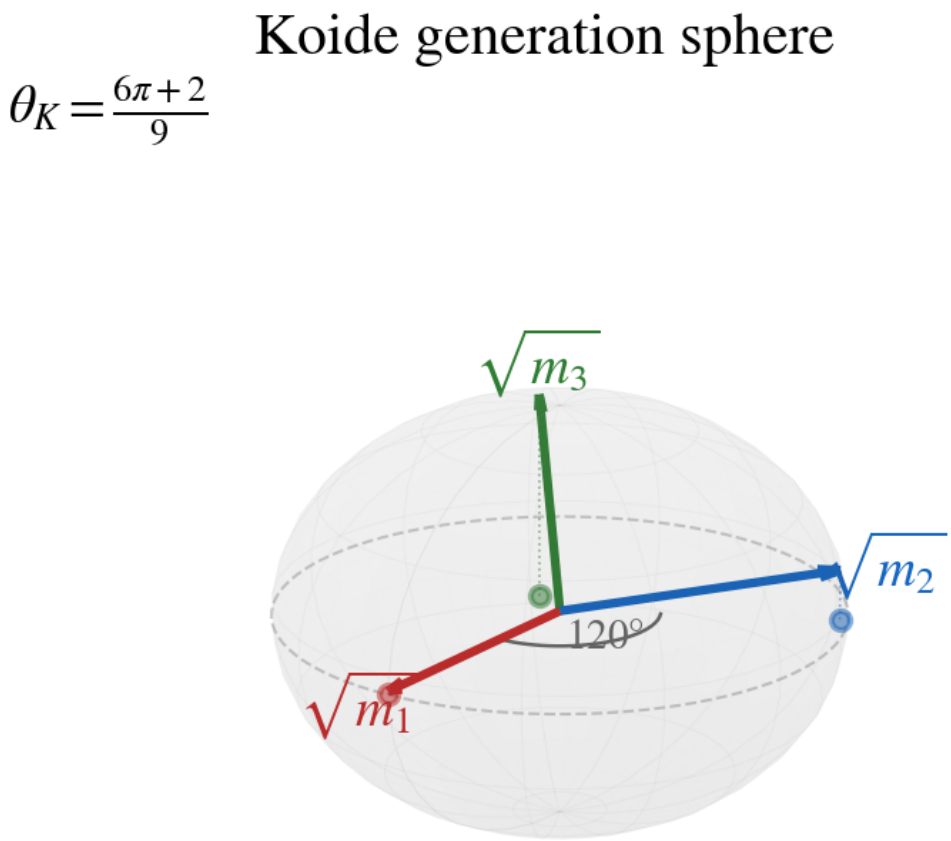

Figure 3: Koide generation sphere. Three mass eigenstates $\sqrt{m_i}$ are represented as unit vectors with 120° azimuthal separation ($\mathbb{Z}_3$ symmetry). The Koide angle $\theta_K = (6\pi + 2)/9$ determines the polar angles. The equatorial projections show the resulting mass ratios.

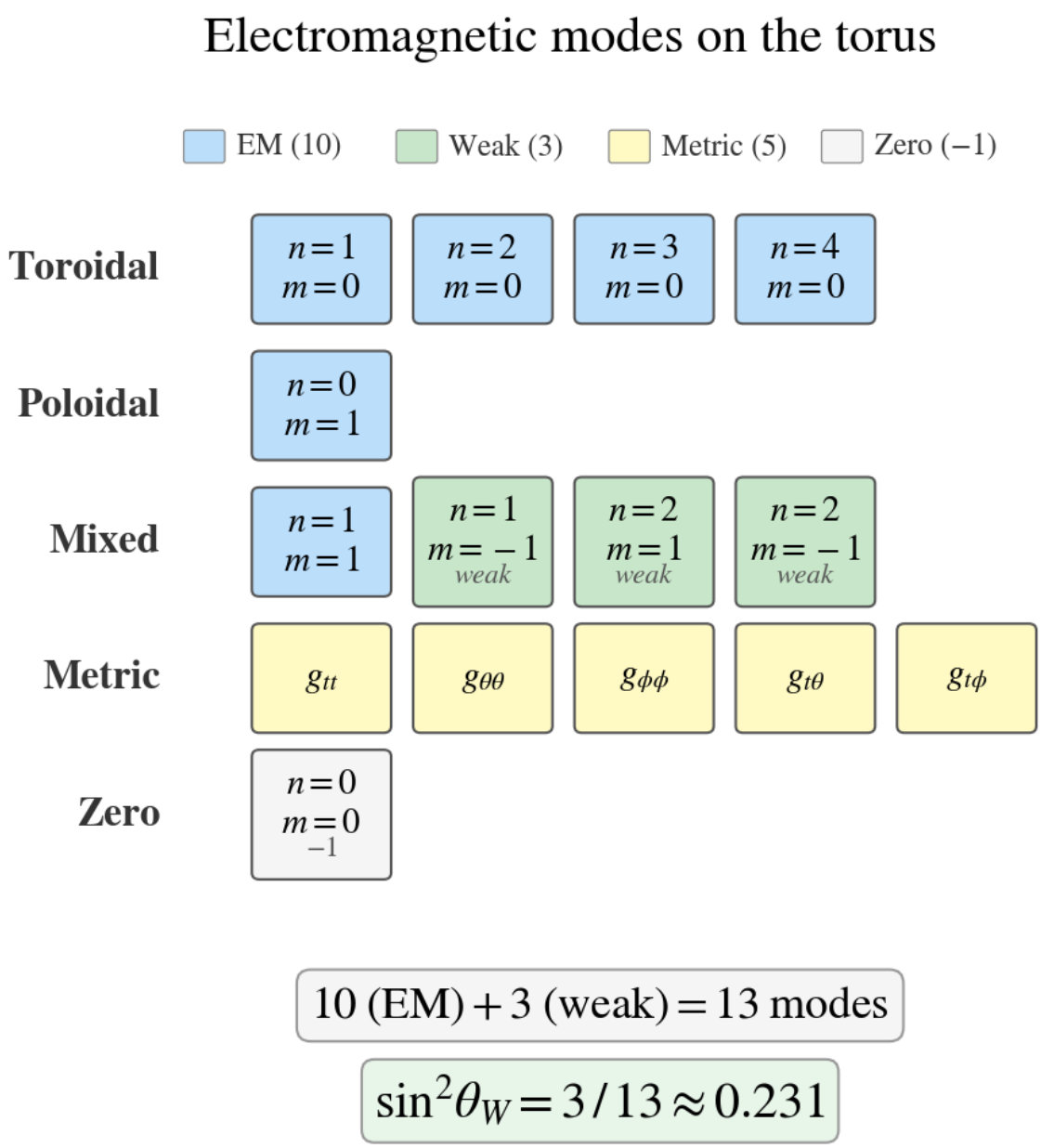

Figure 4: The 13 electromagnetic modes on the $(2, 1)$ torus. Blue: 10 EM-coupled modes (4 toroidal, 1 poloidal, 1 mixed, 4 metric, minus the zero mode). Green: 3 weak-coupled mixed modes. The ratio of weak to total modes gives the Weinberg angle: $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/13 \approx 0.231$.

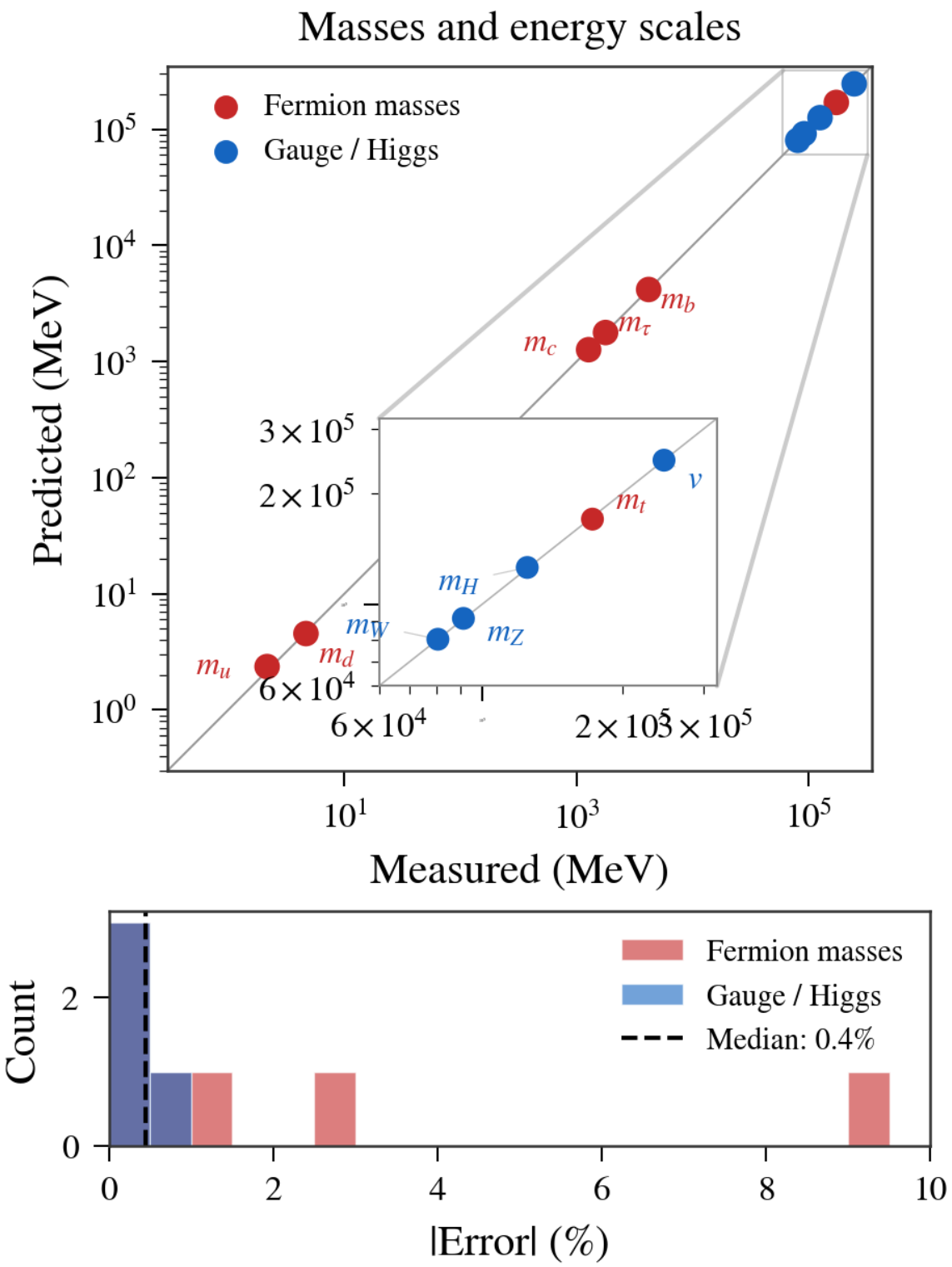

Figure 5: Predicted vs. measured masses and energy scales. Main panel: log-log scatter spanning $m_u \approx 2$ MeV to $v \approx 246$ GeV. Inset: the electroweak cluster (m_W, m_Z, m_H, m_t, v) resolved in GeV. Bottom: error distribution for the mass sector (median 0.4%).

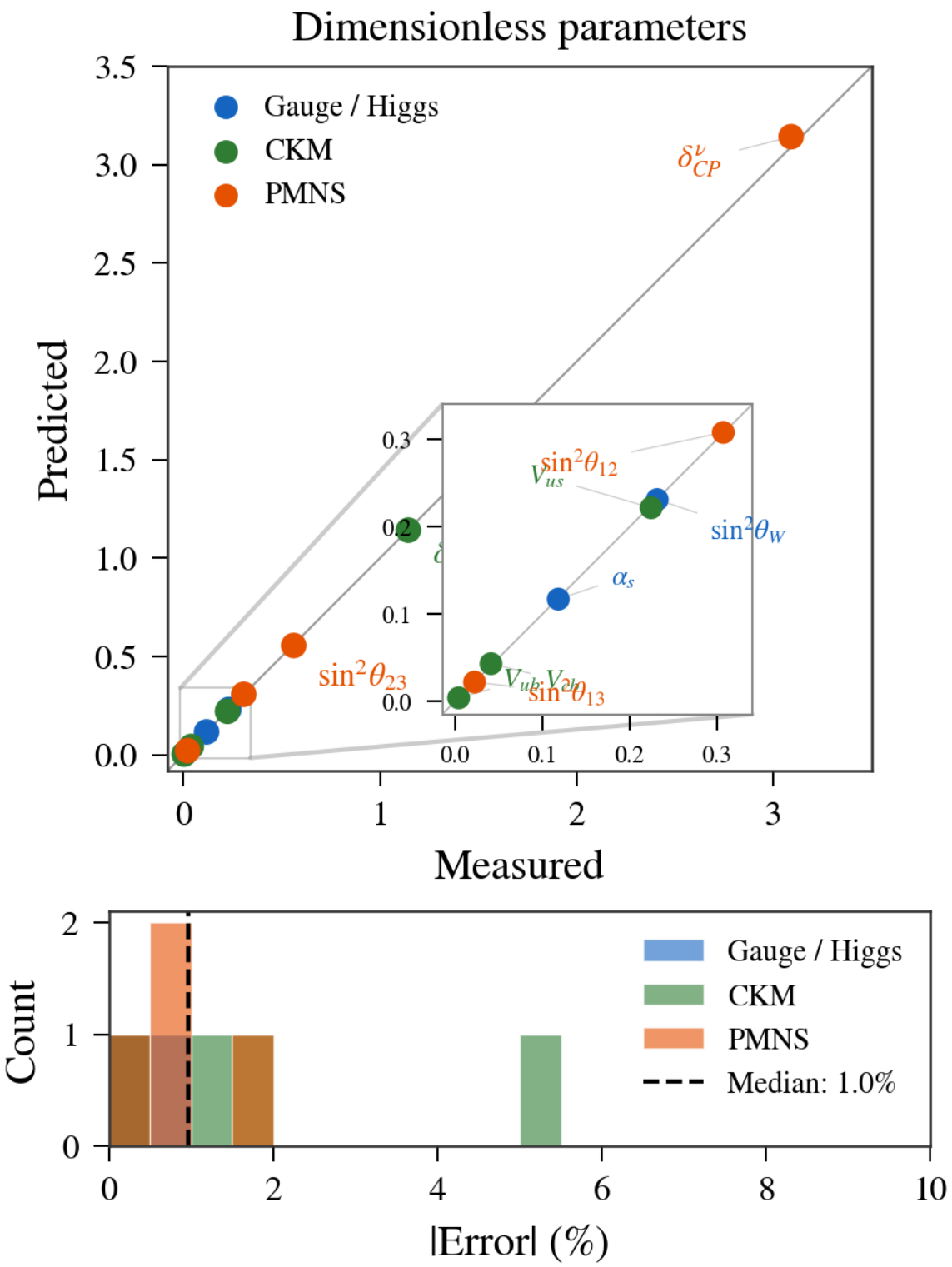

Figure 6: Predicted vs. measured dimensionless parameters. Main panel: linear scatter from $V_{ub} \approx 0.004$ to $\delta^{\nu}_{CP} = \pi$. Inset: the small-value cluster resolved (V_{ub}, $\sin^2\theta_{13}$, V_{cb}, α_s, V_{us}, $\sin^2\theta_W$, $\sin^2\theta_{12}$). Bottom: error distribution for dimensionless parameters (median 1.0%).